

3.1.2 Transport in animals

As animals become larger and more active, transport systems become essential to supply nutrients to, and remove waste from, individual cells.

Controlling the supply of nutrients and removal of waste requires the coordinated activity of the heart and circulatory system.

Learning outcomes	Additional guidance
<i>Learners should be able to demonstrate and apply their knowledge and understanding of:</i>	
(a) the need for transport systems in multicellular animals	To include an appreciation of size, metabolic rate and surface area to volume ratio (SA:V).
	<i>M0.1, M0.3, M0.4, M1.1, M2.1, M4.1</i> HSW1, HSW3, HSW5, HSW8
(b) the different types of circulatory systems	To include single, double, open and closed circulatory systems in insects, fish and mammals.
(c) the structure and functions of arteries, arterioles, capillaries, venules and veins	To include the distribution of different tissues within the vessel walls. PAG2

(d) the formation of tissue fluid from plasma	To include reference to hydrostatic pressure, oncotic pressure and an explanation of the differences in the composition of blood, tissue fluid and lymph. HSW8
(e) (i) the external and internal structure of the mammalian heart (ii) the dissection, examination and drawing of the external and internal structure of the mammalian heart	PAG2 HSW4
(f) the cardiac cycle	To include the role of the valves and the pressure changes occurring in the heart and associated vessels. cardiac output = heart rate × stroke volume HSW2, HSW5, HSW8
(g) how heart action is initiated and coordinated	To include the roles of the sino-atrial node (SAN), atrio-ventricular node (AVN), purkyne tissue and the myogenic nature of cardiac muscle (no detail of hormonal and nervous control is required at AS level). HSW2, HSW5, HSW8
(h) the use and interpretation of electrocardiogram (ECG) traces	To include normal and abnormal heart activity (tachycardia, bradycardia, fibrillation and ectopic heartbeat only). <i>M0.1, M1.1, M1.3, M2.4</i> HSW2, HSW5
(i) the role of haemoglobin in transporting oxygen and carbon dioxide	To include the reversible binding of oxygen molecules, carbonic anhydrase, haemoglobinic acid, hydrogencarbonate ion and the chloride shift. HSW8
(j) the oxygen dissociation curve for fetal and adult human haemoglobin.	To include the significance of the different affinities for oxygen AND the changes to the dissociation curve at different carbon dioxide concentrations (the Bohr effect). <i>M3.1</i> HSW2, HSW8